

COMPOSITION MODEL · PHASE 1 — THE MASTHEAD BAND

Slides as Islands

A slide is a sea plus a fixed set of berths. Phase 1 lifts the eyebrow and title out of content flow into a named masthead band — the body stays put, so every component still composes.

CONTEXT • THE LIFT

The masthead is now a band, not the top of a flow.

The `islands` modifier wraps the eyebrow and the title into a dedicated masthead band with a hairline rule and a reserved right bay. Everything below this rule is the slide body — a clean, separately-addressable region.

Authoring is unchanged: you still write a backtick eyebrow and a `##` `title`. The transform does the lifting across all three render paths.

The band composes with components untouched.

Body stays a section child

Cards, lists, charts, and tables remain direct children of the section, so every `section.X > ...` selector keeps matching. Nothing about the component changes.

Only the masthead moves

The eyebrow and the first heading lift into the band; the rest of the slide is left exactly where the author put it.

One opt-in token

Add `islands` to any content layout. It is incompatible only with `math` and `compare-code`, which drive their own title grid.

EVIDENCE • SAME ENGINE, THREE PATHS

The lift is identical across every render path.

MARP-CLI, THE EMULATOR, AND THE RUNTIME ALL DISPATCH ONE REGISTRY-WIRED TRANSFORM.

3

RENDER PATHS

1

OPT-IN TOKEN

0

COMPONENTS BROKEN

TAKEAWAY • WHAT PHASE 1 BUYS

A named masthead is the foundation the next phases build on.

With the band in place, Phase 2 can drop the meta, logo, and status islands into the reserved bay, and Phase 4 can turn the body into a concrete, centred stage — without re-litigating where the title lives.

KEY INSIGHT

Key insight: name the regions once, and every later island has a berth to dock at.

The masthead has landed.

Next · Phase 2 — meta · progress · status

islands

Inspect this deck against the model in

engineering/decisions/2026-06-11-

islands.md.